

EXPERIMENT 8

Configuring User Management and Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) in a Zoho Creator Application

Hotel Room Booking & Front Office Management

1. Aim

To configure **user management and Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)** in the Hotel Room Booking & Front Office Management application by creating different user roles and assigning appropriate permissions to control access to forms, reports, dashboards, and booking operations.

Objectives

To review the application's live dashboard and confirm the volume of records held across its four forms - Patient Department Links, Appointment Records, Department Masters, and Patient Profiles.

To study the six permission sets available under User Permissions: Department Coordinator, Head of Department, Medical Administrator, Read, Receptionist, and Write.

To construct the role hierarchy CEO Medical Administrator {Head of Department, Department Coordinator, Receptionist}.

To configure a Data Sharing rule, Receptionist_to_Medical_Administrator, sharing Appointment Record data from the Receptionist role to the Medical Administrator role with Read/Write access.

To understand how RBAC separates data ownership (who creates and holds a record) from data visibility (who else may view or edit it).

Software / Tools Required

Zoho Creator (web-based low-code application development platform)

Patient Appointment Scheduling System application (created on Oct 05, 2026)

Web browser with an active internet connection

Zoho account with access to the application in Edit mode

Introduction / Theory

User Management in Zoho Creator

User management decides who can access an application and what each person may see and do within it. Users are added to an application and associated with permission sets (profiles) and roles; together these control access to forms, reports, pages and records. In the Settings area, the User Permissions section groups these controls under three tabs: Permissions, Roles and Data Sharing.

Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)

RBAC is an access-control model in which rights are assigned to roles instead of individual users, and users acquire rights through the roles they hold. It simplifies administration, supports the principle of least privilege, improves data security, and keeps the access policy consistent and easy to audit.

Key Concepts

Concept	Description
Users	Individuals added to the application who sign in to work with its forms, reports and data.
Permissions	Named permission sets (profiles) defining what a user may do with components. This application lists Department Coordinator, Head of Department, Medical Administrator, Read, Receptionist, and Write.

Roles	Positions in the organisational structure (CEO, Medical Administrator, Head of Department, Department Coordinator, Receptionist) that determine a user's place in the hierarchy and the visibility of records.
Role Hierarchy	A tree in which each role reports to another. A higher role can generally view the records of roles beneath it; the reverse does not apply.
Data Sharing	Share rules that extend record visibility beyond the hierarchy, from one role or user to another, with a defined level of access (Read Only or Read/Write).

Application Specifications

Parameter	Detail
Application Name	Patient Appointment Scheduling System
Primary Forms	Patient Profile, Appointment Record, Department Master, Patient Department Link
Dashboard	Summary tiles (Total Patient Department Links, Total Appointment Records, Total Department Masters, Total Patient Profiles), Distribution by Priority Level chart, Review Status tiles, and Distribution by Created By chart
Permission Sets	Department Coordinator, Head of Department, Medical Administrator, Read, Receptionist, Write
Role Hierarchy	CEO → Medical Administrator → {Head of Department, Department Coordinator, Receptionist}
Custom Sharing Rule	Receptionist → Medical Administrator, on Appointment Record, Read/Write access

2. Procedure

Step 1: Open User Management

The **Users and Permissions** section of the Zoho Creator application was opened to manage application users and access permissions.

Step 2: Create Roles

Two roles were created for the application:

- **Front Office Manager**
- **Front Office Staff**

Step 3: Configure Manager Permissions

The **Front Office Manager** role was given full access to the hotel booking application, including creating, viewing, editing, and deleting booking records.

Step 4: Configure Staff Permissions

The **Front Office Staff** role was given limited access to the application. Staff members were allowed to create, view, and edit booking records but were not given permission to delete records.

Step 5: Configure Report Access

Access to the **Room_Booking_Report** was configured for both roles. The manager was given full access, while staff members were given view access.

Step 6: Configure Dashboard Access

The **Hotel Booking Dashboard** was made accessible to both the Front Office Manager and Front Office Staff so that booking information could be viewed by authorized users.

Step 7: Add Users

Test users were added to the application and assigned to their respective roles.

Step 8: Test Role-Based Access

The application was tested by logging in with different user roles. The permissions for creating, viewing, editing, and deleting booking records were verified for each role.

Step 9: Verify Restricted Access

The Front Office Staff account was tested to confirm that restricted operations, such as deleting booking records and accessing application administration, were not permitted.

3. Output

3.1 Creating User Roles

Two roles, **Front Office Manager** and **Front Office Staff**, were successfully created for the Hotel Room Booking application.

Add Role



Name

Front Office Manager

Reports to

CEO



Description

Provides complete access to hotel room booking records, reports, pages, and application management.

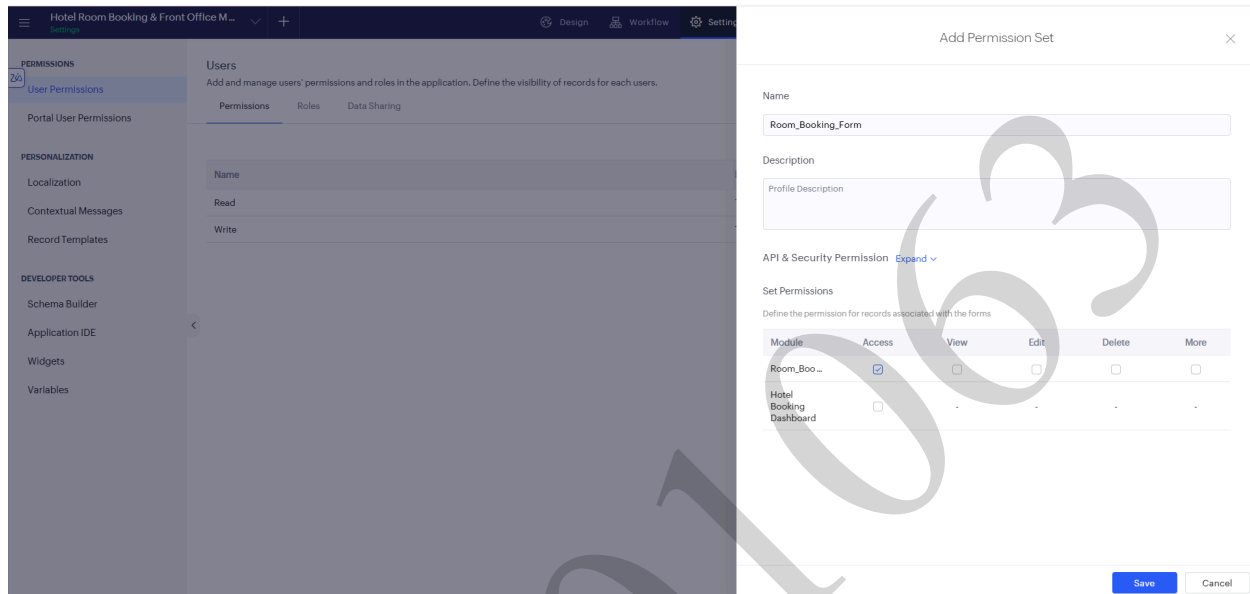
☐ Share Data with Peers

Save

Cancel

3.2 Configuring Manager Permissions

The Front Office Manager was given full access to the booking form and reports, including create, view, edit, and delete permissions.



3.3 Configuring Staff Permissions

The Front Office Staff role was configured with limited permissions. Staff members can create, view, and edit booking records but cannot delete them.

Users

Add and manage users' permissions and roles in the application. Define the visibility of records for each users.

Permissions Roles Data Sharing

Add Permission

Name	Description
Hotel Booking Dashboard	Hotel Booking Dashboard Profile
Read	This profile will have read permission for all components
Room_Booking_Form	Room_Booking_Form Profile
Write	This profile will have write permission for all components

3.4 Adding Users

Users were added to the application and assigned to their corresponding roles.

Users

Add and manage users' permissions and roles in the application. Define the visibility of records for each users.

Permissions Roles Data Sharing

New Share Rule

Name	Form	Shared From	Shared To	Level of access
hotel user list	Room_Booking_Form	R:Front Office Manager	R:Front Office Staff	Read/Write

4. Final Result

User management and **Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)** were successfully configured for the **Hotel Room Booking & Front Office Management** application.

Two roles, **Front Office Manager** and **Front Office Staff**, were created with different levels of permissions. The manager was provided with full access, while staff members were given restricted access to protect important booking and administrative operations.

The application was tested using different user roles, and the configured permissions worked as expected. Thus, **user management and role-based access control were successfully implemented and verified in Zoho Creator.**

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